



unwind

Astronauts and cosmonauts aboard the ISS also fight over who gets to use which toilet. The official policy now is that each team has to use their own national toilets.

Geek culture : Hard Sci-Fi

Hard sci-fi is a genre of science fiction, where the science within the plots, or gameplay is highly accurate. Hard sci-fi typically involves a team of scientists or space explorers playing the main

characters, and possibilities of future developments in existing technology is explored thoroughly. The social, political and economic aspects are also depicted. We've come across books where equations play a part in the plot. Hard sci-fi does not mean that you need multiple doctorates to understand the fiction, just that the technologies involved are explained in detail.

Movies

Contact (1997)

An advanced civilisation receives TV signals from the earth and beams back plans to construct a device that will take one human on an unforgettable journey.



2001: A Space Odyssey (1968)

Probably the most accurate depiction of space exploration in cinema, this movie was so influential that some astronauts reported the monolith on the Moon.



Gattaca (1997)

The consequences of genetic engineering is explored. In this future Earth, your place in society is decided by your genetic makeup.



Books

The Nanotech Chronicles

Michael Flynn explores the fallout of the advent of nanotechnology on the human race. The stories trace the research, tests, deployment and impact of the technology.



A Fall of Moondust

Arthur C Clarke's masterpiece about a lunar tourist vehicle that gets trapped in moon dust. A dramatic rescue attempt by scientists on the Earth and the Moon follows.



The Mars Trilogy

Kim Stanley Robinson's three books, *Red Mars*, *Green Mars* and *Blue Mars* chronicle mankind's efforts to change the face of the red planet and make it habitable.



Concepts

Drake Equation

The Drake equation is an often used equation by Dr. Frank Drake, to calculate the number of civilisations in the galaxy that can communicate with humans.



Occam's Razor

The Occam's Razor is the rule of the thumb for all Hard sci-fi, which states that the simplest possible explanation is probably the correct one.



Clarke's Third Law

The law simply states that "Any sufficiently advanced technology is indistinguishable from magic." The law has seeped firmly into the subconsciousness of every sci-fi fan out there.

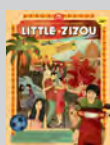


Digit Diary

April was a month of wishful thinking for the team. Technology almost always fell short of the team's high expectations. Vijay came back after a short sabbatical, and was drowned in a large amount of work, making him instantly wish he was back in America. Raaabo wanted cloning technology to be available on a commercial basis, so we could have more people like Vijay. Rossi wanted the dSLRs to come out with models for left-handed people, as only the right-handed people could hold these cameras in the "correct" position. Kumar wished to win

at table tennis, but Siddharth beat him at zero. Nash wished for a new computer so he could play multiplayer games with the team, and got one too. Michael wished he would permanently get to keep the ergonomic chairs that came in for testing. A little into the month, he wished the ergonomic chairs hadn't come in for testing in the first place, as he had a tendency to nod off when he was sitting in one of them. Aditya wished the Republic would have cloned Rajnikanth instead of Jango Fett. Everyone has something ready for the next time they see a shooting star, or find one of those magic lamps.

How we unwind



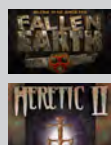
Movies

Little Zizou: A Parsi boy's views on his community.
Sita Sings the Blues: A free animated feature length movie about an epic breakup.



Music

The Dark Side of Phobos: A free electronica album with tracks from Doom remixed.
Stadium Arcadium: The team can't have enough of RHCP.



Game

Fallen Earth (Closed Beta): An MMO in a post-apocalyptic America.
Heretic II: One of the classics we still like to play.